About the Author



Sir Chandrasekhara Venkata Raman (7 November 1888 – 21 November 1970) was an Indian physicist born in Tiruchirappalli. He carried out ground-breaking work in the field of light scattering, which earned him the 1930 Nobel Prize for Physics. He discovered that when light traverses a transparent material, some of the deflected light changes wavelength. This phenomenon, subsequently known as Raman scattering, results from the Raman effect and to commemorate it, February-28 is celebrated as National Science Day. In 1954, India honoured him with its highest civilian award, the Bharat Ratna.

Glossary

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elixir (n) - a hypothetical substance believed to maintain life indefinitely/ a substance believed to cure all ills

billowing (adj.) - characterized by great swelling waves or surges

teeming (adj.) - abundantly filled especially with living things

trickling (v) - to flow slowly and with out force

precipitate (v) - a solid substance that is produced from a liquid during a chemical process

crust (n) - a hard outer covering of something

catchment (n) - a structure, such as a basin or a reservoir, used for collecting or draining water

barges (n) - a long boat with a flat bottom, used for carrying freight on rivers

A. Answer the following questions briefly in one or two sentences.

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1. What makes water one of the most powerful and wonderful things on earth?
2. How does water help in the formation of fertile lands?
3. How does soil erosion happen and what are its main causes?
4. What are some measures that are used to prevent soil erosion?
5. How, according to Sir C. V. Raman, can rainwater as well as the water of rivers be prevented from going to waste?

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